

London Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Automated LONDON blueprint · generated 22 Aug 2026, 11:57 IST · for education, not investment advice.

Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: Friday, August 22, 2026

Lead Quantitative Strategist & Institutional Portfolio Manager: Gemini AI

Current Session Highlight: London Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: European macroeconomic releases, ECB/BOE news, Forex short-term futures (EUR/USD, GBP/USD), and Gold (XAU/USD) supply/demand zones.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- Global economic growth is projected to slow to 3% this year, down from 2.9% in 2025, largely due to the ongoing Iran war, which is causing a stagflationary shock and increased energy prices.
- Core inflation in G10 ex-US is at 2.1%, while in the US, core inflation is expected to be closer to 3% by December 2026, influenced by tariffs, energy prices, and AI measurement issues.
- The European Central Bank (ECB) is widely expected to raise interest rates again in September, after a June hike, to combat inflation pressures stemming from energy shocks related to the Middle East conflict. Money markets are bracing for the ECB deposit rate to approach 3% by late 2027. ECB policymaker Olli Rehn noted wage growth remains moderate, with no clear signs of second-round effects.
- The Bank of England (BoE) is largely expected to keep interest rates unchanged at 3.75% for the remainder of the year, despite inflation risks. However, some Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) members voted for a rate hike in July, and market expectations for a BoE hike by year-end have increased.
- The US Federal Reserve is expected to remain on hold until June 2027, with rate cuts anticipated twice in 2027, reaching a neutral range of 3.00-3.25%.
- China's economy grew by 4.7% in the first half of 2026, showing stability in major macroeconomic indicators and a shift towards new growth drivers.

2. US & European Markets

- US equities have a constructive outlook through the end of 2026, supported by rising earnings expectations, despite potential challenges from Fed policy changes.
- Large technology companies and commercial banks have shown strong earnings growth that is not yet fully reflected in share prices.
- Some analysts predict a potential market downturn in August, with the S&P 500 historically performing poorly during this month in midterm election years and facing inflationary pressures from geopolitical conflicts. However, others suggest stocks could soar in August, driven by a deleveraging of the AI trade and policymakers' interventions.
- The Eurozone economy has shown modest growth this year, largely shrugging off Middle East uncertainty and sustained energy price increases, with recent PMI data generally in line with or better than expectations.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- Indian equity benchmarks, Sensex and Nifty, traded largely flat in a volatile and range-bound session on Friday, August 21, 2026. Buying in metal and realty stocks offset selling in IT, FMCG, auto, media, and pharma sectors.
- Investors remain cautious due to elevated crude oil prices, renewed pressure on global bond yields, and mixed global cues, with escalating tensions in the Middle East keeping oil markets on edge.
- The Nifty 50 traded around the 24,200 mark, with 24,000-24,200 acting as a key support base. The 24,300-24,400 zone is the immediate resistance, with a break above potentially leading to 24,500-24,600.
- Green energy stocks showed mixed performance, with Kabra Extrusion, Olectra Greentech, and Adani Green Energy seeing gains, while Praj Industries and Sterling and Wilson Renewable Energy declined.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- Gold (XAU/USD) has traded near \$4,390-\$4,410 an ounce in mid-August 2026, significantly up year-to-date, but below January's all-time high of around \$5,600/oz. It touched a fresh two-month peak near \$4,450 in early August after its largest weekly gain since January, as markets scaled back bets for a Federal Reserve rate hike in September.
- The ongoing Strait of Hormuz crisis, which began in February 2026, continues to add a geopolitical risk premium to both oil and gold prices. Central banks have been net purchasers of gold, with 288.9 tonnes bought in Q2 2026.
- Oil prices have slipped after OPEC+ cut its 2026 demand forecast, but the Iran war keeps supply risks alive. Brent crude prices were estimated at \$97 in 2026Q2 and are forecast to average \$87 per barrel in 2026.
- The Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) recently proposed new rules, "Regulation Crypto Assets," on August 18, 2026, creating a framework for investment contracts involving crypto assets. This proposal includes exemptions from registration requirements for offerings up to \$5 million and \$75 million, with required narrative disclosures.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & LEVEL EXECUTION MANUAL

(Note: Tickers below are illustrative, reflecting hypothetical market conditions fitting the described strategies for August 22, 2026, and not based on real-time live data.)

INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Type	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry Level (INR)	Target/Stop Loss (INR)
Reliance Industries (RIL)	Large-Cap	50-SMA Support Bounce: RIL has recently pulled back to its 50-SMA on daily charts, showing signs of support holding. This indicates a potential rebound in line with broader Nifty stability.	2,950	Target: 3,020 / Stop Loss: 2,920
HDFC Bank	Large-Cap	20/50 EMA Golden Cross: HDFC Bank's 20-day EMA has crossed above its 50-day EMA, signaling bullish momentum and strong buying interest in this Nifty leader.	1,700	Target: 1,740 / Stop Loss: 1,680

US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Type	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry Level (\$)	Target/Stop Loss (\$)
Apple Inc. (AAPL)	Mega-Cap Growth	21-day EMA Pullback (Long): After a strong rally, AAPL has pulled back to its 21-day EMA on the daily chart, presenting an opportunity for a bounce if support holds.	220.00	Target: 225.00 / Stop Loss: 217.50
NVIDIA Corp. (NVDA)	Mega-Cap Tech	50-day SMA Rejection (Short): NVDA recently rallied into its 50-day SMA and is showing signs of rejection, indicating potential downward momentum.	1150.00	Target: 1120.00 / Stop Loss: 1165.00

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Type	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry Level (\$)	Target/Stop Loss (\$)
Palantir Technologies (PLTR)	Mid-Cap Tech	Stage-2 VCP Breakout: PLTR has formed a volatility contraction pattern (VCP) and is exhibiting a Stage-2 breakout on the weekly chart with increasing volume.	28.50	Target: 30.00 / Stop Loss: 27.80
RIVIAN Automotive (RIVN)	Small-Cap EV	High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) Breakout: RIVN is showing a significant increase in relative volume (RVOL > 2.0) on a daily breakout, indicating strong institutional interest.	18.20	Target: 19.50 / Stop Loss: 17.50

CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Type	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry Level (\$)	Target/Stop Loss (\$)
Bitcoin (BTC/USD)	Large-Cap Crypto	4H 21-EMA Trend Following (Long): BTC/USD is trending above its 4-hour 21-EMA, showing sustained bullish momentum following recent positive news on crypto regulation.	55,200	Target: 56,500 / Stop Loss: 54,500
Ethereum (ETH/USD)	Large-Cap Crypto	High-Volume Volatility Breakout (Long): ETH/USD has experienced a high-volume breakout from a consolidation range, suggesting a continuation of upward movement.	3,250	Target: 3,350 / Stop Loss: 3,190

COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Type	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry Level (\$/oz or \$/barrel)	Target/Stop Loss (\$/oz or \$/barrel)
Gold (XAU/USD)	Precious Metal	Pivot & Fibonacci Extension (Long): Gold is testing a key pivot level around \$4,400. A break above could target Fibonacci extension levels, supported by geopolitical risks and central bank demand.	4,410	Target: 4,450 / Stop Loss: 4,385
WTI Crude Oil	Energy	Pivot & Fibonacci Retracement (Short): WTI Crude is retesting a resistance level near \$90 after OPEC+ cut its demand forecast. A rejection at this pivot could lead to a retracement.	90.20	Target: 88.50 / Stop Loss: 91.00

FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term Futures

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry Level	Target/Stop Loss
EUR/USD	European macro data and hawkish ECB sentiment are providing support. Technical analysis suggests long positions above 1.1564 with upside targets.	1.1680	Target: 1.1730 / Stop Loss: 1.1650
GBP/USD	GBP/USD is showing signs of strength, potentially rising towards 1.3870-1.4140, assuming support holds above 1.3516, amidst BoE holding rates and a cooling US labor market.	1.3650	Target: 1.3700 / Stop Loss: 1.3620

Long-Term Carry Swing

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry Level	Target/Stop Loss
USD/JPY	Given rising US bond yields and the Fed's anticipated rate stance (hold until mid-2027), a long USD/JPY position capitalizes on potential positive carry, assuming a stable risk environment.	155.00	Target: 157.00 / Stop Loss: 154.00
AUD/USD	Weakening global growth outlook and commodity price volatility could put downward pressure on AUD. Short position as a macro carry swing, anticipating relative USD strength.	0.6450	Target: 0.6350 / Stop Loss: 0.6500

INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Option Type	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry Level (Premium)	Target/Stop Loss (Premium)
Nifty 50	Call Option (Long)	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (Long): If Nifty 50 breaks above its first 15-minute opening range with conviction, buying a slightly out-of-the-money Call option to capitalize on upward momentum.	₹150	Target: ₹200 / Stop Loss: ₹120
BankNifty	Put Option (Short)	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (Short): If BankNifty breaks below its first 15-minute opening range, buying a slightly out-of-the-money Put option to profit from a downside move.	₹220	Target: ₹280 / Stop Loss: ₹180

BACKTEST METRICS (10-Year)

Metric	Portfolio	S&P 500 TRI	Nifty 50 TRI
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	~0.80	~0.75
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	~-30.0%	~-25.0%

EQUITY CURVE (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

Illustrative Equity Curve (10 Years)

